Update Conference
PRAGUE 2026

Adoption is the hard part

Eight and a half months of MCP in production at an HVAC company

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Not a software company

We install and maintain heating, cooling, ventilation and building automation in larger buildings.
Small IT team, no AI department.

350
people

18
MCP servers in production

114
agent-facing tools
what an agent can call

8
MCP Apps
charts, maps, forms for writes

across ERP · estimating · BIM · building automation · energy · tickets · product data

Most MCP work is for developers. Ours is for people who don’t write code.

A contract manager built a client report. Nobody in IT asked for it.

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
built with AI	own prep	in the meeting	sent ahead	client noticed	shared	made standard	in the library	on a schedule

One report: three years of service history for one client.

Now it goes to the client before the meeting.

And the clients say: “you come across as proactive, not reactive.”

How does a contract manager build that?

And this talk is called “adoption is the hard part”. **Is it?**

START · USE · BUILD

Two adoption groups

At the start: about 25 people used ChatGPT now and then. AI was nobody’s daily driver, not even in IT.

Two adoption groups, many agent harnesses

INSIDE IT · HARNESSES TO BUILD WITH

ChatGPT → + GitHub Copilot → Cursor → Cursor + Claude → VS Code + Claude → + Codex → **Claude Code + Codex CLI**

Six setups in nine months. **Now: AI-native, without an IDE.**

OUTSIDE IT · HARNESSES TO WORK WITH

ChatGPT → Copilot / ChatGPT → **Claude / ChatGPT, connected to our data** → Mistral? our own harness?

Generic answers, until our data and its meaning arrived. **Now: AI-enabled.**

A better harness was never enough: IT needed a way of working, the rest needed business data.

INSIDE IT · THE MOMENT IT CLICKED

IT went first, eventually all the way

> **“Typing the code is no longer part of my job. Writing down exactly what has to exist, and checking what comes out: that is the job now.”**
>
> one of our developers

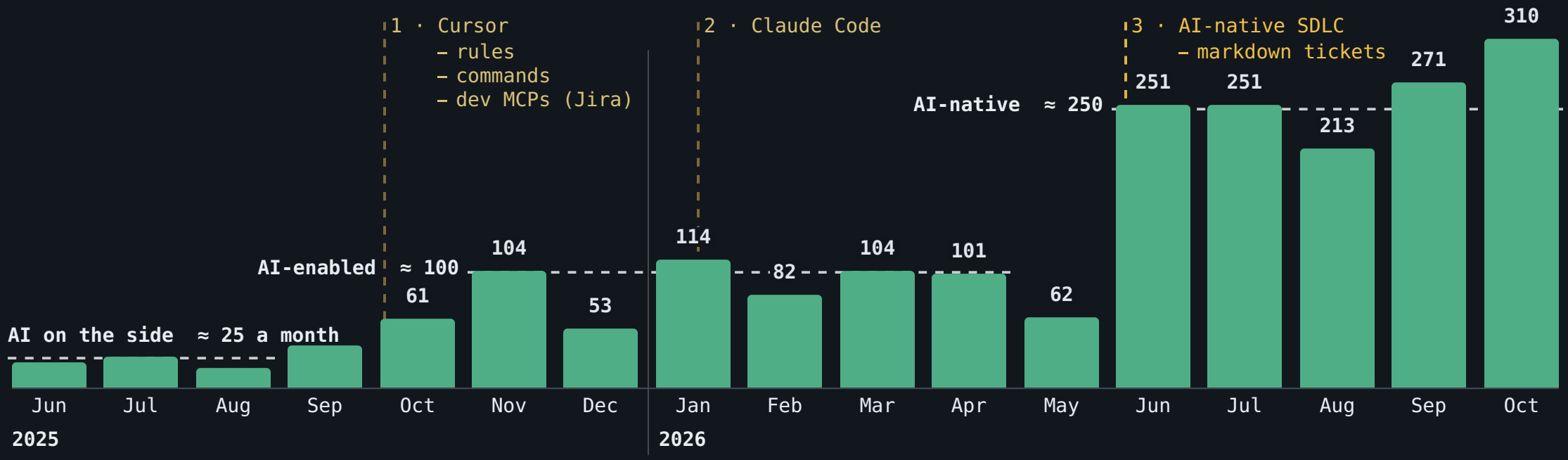
- **Some colleagues** got no course but an assignment: build a spec-driven product of your own, A to Z, something you will actually use. It convinced them: **“I can do more with AI than I thought.”**

100% of IT. Some got there by building something they needed.

INSIDE IT · MEASURED

IT went first: from tool to way of working

merged pull requests per month, whole team · per working day: 1.15 → 2.9 → 11.1



AI on the side: 25 a month. AI-enabled: 100. AI-native: 250.

INSIDE IT · WHAT CHANGED IN JUNE

An AI-native SDLC: moving review to the plan

ONE TICKET BOARD, EVERY STEP A SKILL

ticket
HUMAN + AI
you ask, the agent writes it from the code

→

plan
AI
the agent

→

plan review
AI + HUMAN(S)
a second AI, then the builder, ideally with a colleague

→

build
AI
the agent

→

code review
AI, SOMETIMES HUMAN
a second AI, sometimes a colleague

→

test
AI + HUMAN
the agent tests, a human does the final check

ONE BOARD, ONE MCP

Tickets are markdown next to the code, as agent memory. One viewer and one MCP server across all repos.

HUMAN CODE REVIEW

↓ 25%

of PRs only, and going down. No mandatory code review.

ANY STACK

One synced workflow for Angular and TypeScript, .NET and Java, with skills per language.

Parallel work, with control. Less experienced developers doing higher-level work.

OUTSIDE IT · FEBRUARY 2026

Colleagues will ask an AI agent about our systems, in plain language. What tells the agent what the data means?

OUTSIDE IT · A COLLEAGUE ASKS THE AGENT

“Is this building at risk of overheating?”

one building in Rotterdam · one field

temperatuuroverschrijding: **3.59** *temperature exceedance*

what the model gets

unit	*none given*
limit	*none given*

↓

reads as **?**

> 3.59 hours a year
> 3.59 degrees

MODEL GUESS

“**Low risk**”: under 40 hours, or under 5 to 6 °C.

the capability answers

verdict	SIGNIFICANT, over 1.5
unit	none, not °C or hours

↓

computed by the server

> **over twice the limit**

GROUNDED

“**Significant risk**: 3.59 against a limit of 1.5.”

3.59. Nothing in the response says of what.

OUTSIDE IT · WHAT WE DID ABOUT IT

The bet: put the meaning in the capability

RENTED

THE INTERFACE

The agent harness is the UI: Claude, ChatGPT, whatever people already use. No chat app to build.

BUILT

THE BET: THE MCP CAPABILITY LAYER

Domain semantics

Interpretation rules

Computed values

Alerts and boundaries

Usage guidance

ALREADY OWNED

SECURITY

Our identity provider and its roles.

ALREADY OWNED

HOSTING

The cloud we already pay for.

Rented the harness. Built the meaning. Scaled capabilities, not agents.

YOU'VE HEARD *"Clean your data first."* ✗

We didn't wait for clean data

01 · ON THE REAL DATA

AI finds what is off

safety certificate (VCA)
exam_date: impossible
birth_date: missing

02 · A WARNING IN THE CAPABILITY

Answers stay right

⚠ dates incomplete or impossible: flag the record, do not count it as valid

03 · AT THE SOURCE

Fixed, so the warning goes

a data-quality list for HR, fixed in the system

Don't clean first. Clean while you find out.

YOU'VE HEARD *"Find your champions."* ✓

One person, one problem, fixed the next day

DAY 1 · THEY ASK

One real problem

their own work, in their own words

→

DAY 2 · IT IS THERE

A prompt to try

often built that evening

→

AFTER

A user, not a request

and the next question comes by itself

A MODELLER component data from datasheets: ~~an afternoon~~ → **minutes, ready to check**

A champion opens the door. A fix the next day makes them stay.

START · USE · BUILD

Would everyone use it?

training, what brought them back, who didn’t get started, and what was hard

YOU'VE HEARD *"Train everyone."* ◐

How I train: small groups, hands-on

01 **The basics first:** models, tokens, context.

02 **Data everyone may see:** a colleague's job title. Then their salary: **no.**

03 **Their own data:** "What is the status of my project?"

04 **What not to ask:** "Who is our best project manager?"

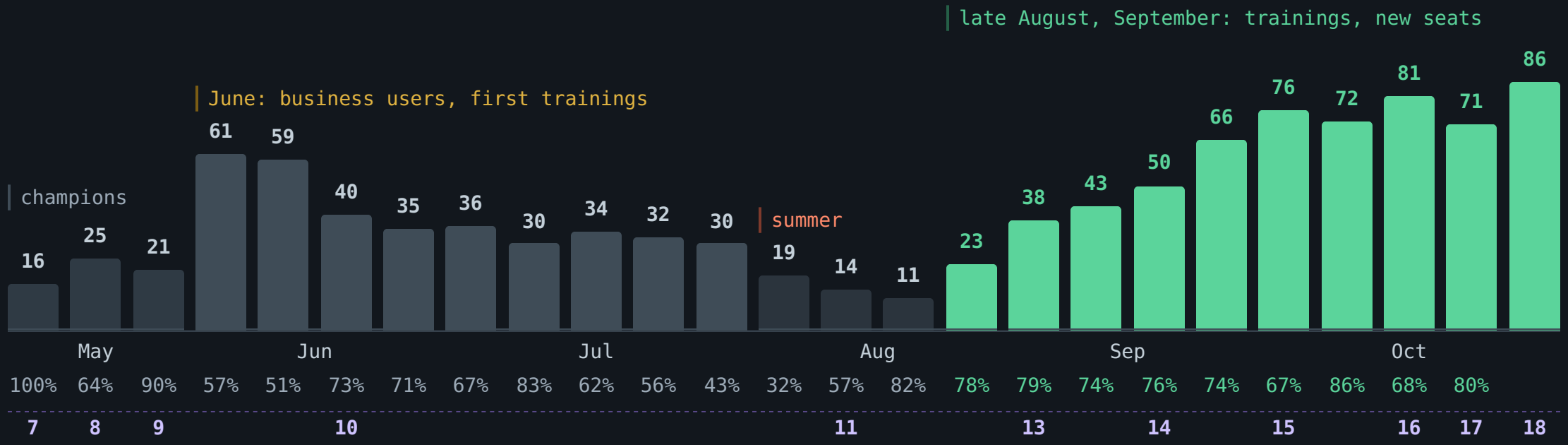
05 **Skills:** save a workflow, improve it, share it.

06 **The advanced part:** live dashboards and scheduled work.

After every training, a few people come back the next day to show what they built.

Since late August, they keep coming back

people per week using AI on **our business data** · below: back next week · violet: MCP servers in production



The group more than tripled, and more of them came back each week.

More doors into the agent

SEEING IS BELIEVING

Charts and tables of your own project

MCP Apps in the conversation, to check the answer yourself, or to see more in it.

A GAME

Tetris, with a leaderboard

Between rounds it suggests a prompt that fits your role.

A FASTER TICKET

IT requests through the agent

It asks what a vague request leaves out, checks earlier tickets, offers help. Complete requests get picked up sooner.

SIDE BY SIDE

A day next to one person

Anything they want to do with Claude. It works, but it does not scale.

The game got a laugh. The ticket got users.

Not everyone got started

ONE ATTITUDE

“This can’t. That can’t. That can’t either.”

THE OTHER

“Could it do this? Could it also do that?”

- **Some saw it work, and still said: “AI is for IT.”** After a training, on their own data.
- **Some don’t want to.** I have learned to respect that.
- **Some say: “AI can’t do my work.”** Their work feels too special for it.
- **Some wait for someone else’s AI workflow.** Fine: not everyone has to build.
- **Some can’t put their work into words.** Then IT writes the skill with them.

It is the question you ask, and the mindset you bring.

What was hard

01 **The first answer decides.** One generic answer, and AI was judged.

02 **Chicken and egg.** No use without a need, no need without use.

03 **Keeping up, with a small IT team.** Eighteen servers to keep right.

04 **Designing the interface for agents.** One server, many clients.

05 **Proving the value.** Every time saving is self-reported.

None of this was about the model.

What got people started

01 **One question everybody has,** on data anyone may see.

02 **One ambassador who knows that data,** and checks the first answers.

03 **Put the meaning in the capability,** not in a prompt.

04 **Train on their own data,** and end with their own skill.

05 **Fix the first request the next day,** so a request becomes a user.

One problem, one ambassador, one trustworthy capability. Then the next one.

START · USE · BUILD

They started making their own

first steps towards AI-native: skills, agents, and software nobody asked for

KNOWLEDGE THAT LIVED IN HEADS

What people build: skills

FINANCIAL ADMINISTRATION

Which instalment invoices can go out?

The rules lived in heads: check the instalment schedule against the project file, the actual project costs and the purchase invoices. Now a skill does that per project, and flags what can be invoiced.

PREFAB ENGINEERING

Every cut, groove and weld, counted by hand

Hundreds to thousands per project, typed into Excel. Now how to read a drawing is written down once. The agent counts with their own standard times per operation; the team checks each drawing.

“Our work has shifted from counting and retyping by hand to checking and assessing.”

the prefab engineering team (translated)

AND MANY MORE · 20 IN THE LIBRARY

tender quickscan | subcontractor agreement | IFC export | quarterly report

> One library, synced to our agent harnesses. **Mandatory once shared with more than two people.**

Written down once. Run every time.

YOU'VE HEARD *"Keep a human in the loop."* ✓

The analyst's skill, IT's controlled write

THE ENERGY ANALYST BUILT

A comment under every chart, every week

The thresholds lived in their head. Now the skill applies them to every building and energy stream: same week, same assessment.

IT BUILT

An MCP App approval form

The model has no write tool. It proposes the comments; the form opens in the conversation; only the form writes to the production system.

`1 · the skill proposes` → `2 · the analyst edits and approves` → `3 · the form writes, once`

The expert brings the knowledge, IT brings the controlled write. The boundary sits outside the model.

BACK TO THE CONTRACT MANAGER

What people build: personal agents

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
built with AI	own prep	in the meeting	sent ahead	client noticed	shared	made standard	in the library	on a schedule

ONE PROMPT

Prepare the contract review for this client. The last three years.

THE CAPABILITIES SUPPLY

service calls, work orders, installations, contract lines, technician notes

THE SKILL DOES

calls grouped per installation, what is still open, a recommendation in house style

THEY CHECK, THEN SEND

Read, correct, decide what goes out. Before the meeting.

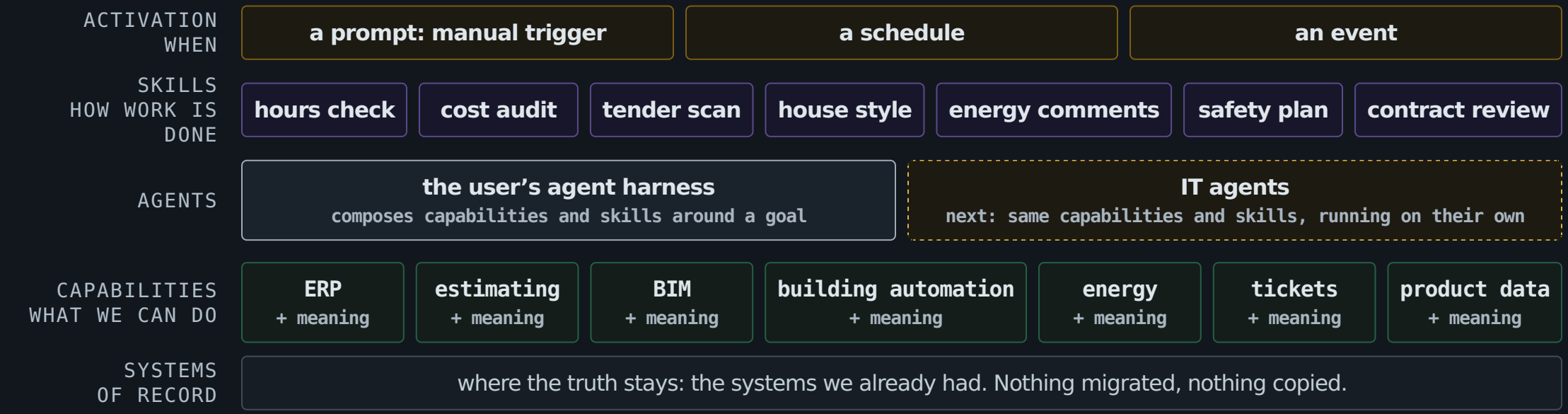
Now: a standard skill in the department’s library. **And no prompt at all:** it runs on a schedule from their agenda and prepares each client meeting.

Other colleagues are starting to do the same.

We never built an agent for contract managers. One of them has one now.

THE FULL PICTURE · SKILLS AND ACTIVATION ON TOP OF THE CAPABILITIES

How it all fits together



Build the capabilities once. Every agent uses them, the user’s and ours.

When everybody can build: who owns it?

DASHBOARDS

Live pages on our MCP tools

Built by the people who use them. One hammered our servers, and showed the wrong numbers.

who checks the numbers?

A WEB APPLICATION

A calculation app, by a non-programmer

It used to be Excel. Now a Python app on a laptop, with a JSON-based database. No tests.

who guards software quality?

A SOFTWARE TOOL

A Revit add-in, by the BIM team

Built with Claude Code, saves a licence per user every year. In a repository; IT reviews the code.

the arrangement that works

UNASKED

PoCs, designs, mockups

Nobody asked for them. Often good, sometimes very good.

and every one is ours to judge

WHAT WE PREPARED a skills library with IT approval · repositories with code review · Teams channels to share what works

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The builder owns what it should do. IT owns how it runs.

FEB 2026	**We thought adoption would be the hard part.**
NOV 2026	**Handling what everyone can do with it is.**
JEVONS	Almost ten times the output. IT busier than ever.

Are you ready for when adoption works?

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Give feedback

Thank you

If your organisation is past the point where people need convincing: tell me what broke next.

Scan for the repo

- the slides of this talk
- the capability architecture
- a reference MCP server

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